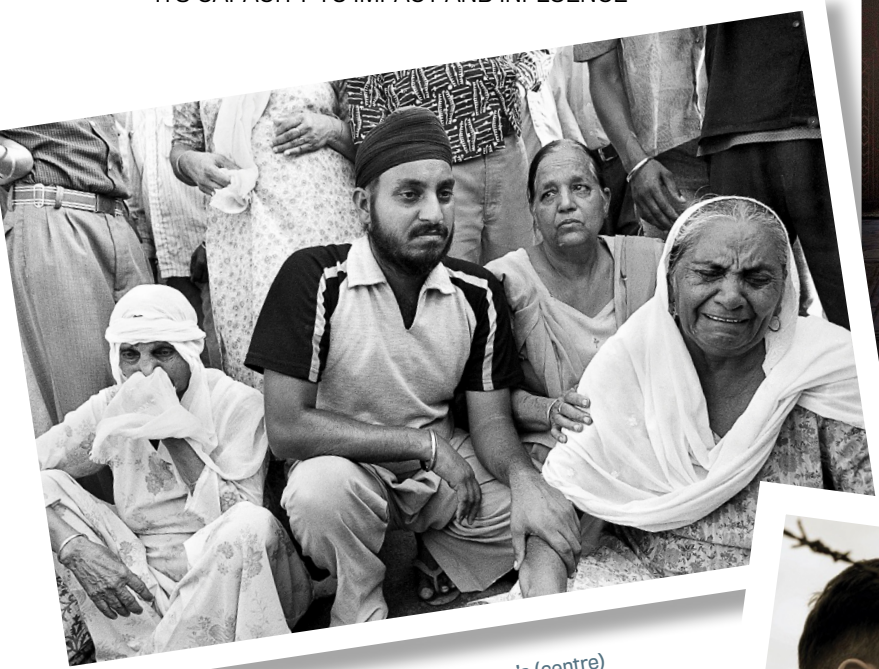
PHOTOGRAPHY

BACK TO THE FUTURE

THE THIRD EDITION OF THE **CHENNAI PHOTO BIENNALE** RETHINKS PHOTOGRAPHY AND ITS CAPACITY TO IMPACT AND INFLUENCE







AN UNEASE (clockwise from left) Taranjeet Kaur's (centre) grandfather Jeevan Singh was killed on Nov. 1, 1984– excerpted from the 1984 notebooks by Gauri Gill; 'I travel therefore I am' by Vamika Jain; 'Stories from a Forgotten War' by Parvathi Nayar & Nayantara Nayar

INTERVIEW

Elephant in the Room

For **SENTHIL KUMARAN**, *the human-pachyderm conflict "is one of most important contemporary issues in India that we don't often get to hear". At the Chennai Photo Biennale, the Madurai-based wildlife photographer is showcasing 25 portraits of mahouts and conflict elephants from* Tamed Tuskers, *a series he shot in and around Tamil Nadu's Theppakadu Elephant Camp.*

Q. Tell us about the core theme of *Tamed Tuskers*?
Tamed Tuskers is one of the chapters of my photographic journey in wildlife. It explores the special relationships mahouts share with elephants. Wild elephants raid crops and get into trouble. When they kill local people, they are moved to training camps, sometimes with the help of *kumkis* (trained elephants). The mahout becomes their guide or friend, and most elephants have strong associative memories with them.

Q. Did you befriend any elephant during the course of your wildlife career?
Not as such, but I find them to be highly intelligent, emotional and perceptive. I once trailed an elephant called Moorthy who had killed 23 people. Villagers had chased him with guns and injured him. Later, the Kurumba tribe caught him and treated him gently. After the training, Moorthy became one of the

